AGILE TEAM CHARTER

Village Water Supply

Muraleni Community Water Delivery Service



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1. Team Purpose

Objective

This team exists to design and build a digital platform that brings structure and fairness to the water supply system in Muraleni village, Makhado, Limpopo. The platform will serve two primary user groups: administrators who operate the water delivery business, and borehole owners who supply the water. Administrators will be able to manage orders, track deliveries, and oversee payments, while borehole owners will have full visibility into how much water they have provided and how much they are owed. The goal is to replace an informal and often exploitative system with one that is transparent, reliable and easy to use for everyone involved.

Vision Statement

Water is not a privilege. In Muraleni, it has long been treated as one. Families without boreholes wake up every day uncertain of whether they will be able to cook, bathe or wash. They walk to homes that may or may not have owners present, pay prices that change without warning, and return empty-handed with no recourse. This is not a rural inconvenience. It is a structural failure that repeats itself daily across dozens of villages across South Africa.

Our vision is a community in which access to water is guaranteed, predictable and affordable. We want residents to be able to place an order and have water delivered to their door. We want borehole owners to be fairly compensated and to trust that their earnings are tracked honestly. We want administrators to have real tools to run the business, not guesswork and handwritten records. And we want this model to be replicable, because Muraleni is one of many villages facing the same problem.

Technology alone does not solve access to water. But it can make the system around it work better for the people who need it most. That is what this platform is being built to do.

2. Team Roles and Responsibilities

Name	Student No.	Role	Responsibilities
Mologadi Dikgale	[redacted]	Project Manager	Leads sprint planning and retrospectives, manages the backlog, tracks progress, facilitates team communication and removes blockers
Uhmar Adams	[redacted]	Lead Developer	Owns the technical architecture, conducts code reviews, sets development standards and coordinates integration between frontend and backend
Leeroy Chakanyuka	[redacted]	Backend Developer	Builds and maintains REST APIs, designs the database schema, implements business logic for the admin and borehole owner portals
Faith Adams	222297204	UI/UX Designer	Creates wireframes and user flows, designs the admin and borehole owner dashboards, and ensures a clear and accessible user experience
Phatushedzo Baloyi	[redacted]	QA Tester	Writes test plans, performs functional and regression testing, documents bugs and validates that acceptance criteria are met before each release



3. Team Values and Principles

Core Values

- **Community first**: every feature we build, every decision we make, is evaluated against one question: does this make life easier for the people of Muraleni? The platform exists to serve the community, not the other way around.
- **Transparency**: we operate openly. Within the team, that means honest stand-ups, clear documentation, and no surprises. Within the platform, that means borehole owners always know what they are owed and administrators always know what is happening.
- **Accountability**: each team member owns their area completely. If something is late, we say so early. If something is broken, we fix it. We do not pass blame; we solve problems.
- **Respect**: we come from different backgrounds and carry different strengths. Every voice in this team has weight. Disagreements are resolved with evidence and conversation, not hierarchy.
- **Fairness**: the water problem in Muraleni is partly a fairness problem. Prices change arbitrarily, borehole owners are not always paid what they are due, and residents with less money suffer more. Our platform is designed to make the system fairer, and we hold ourselves to that same standard internally.
- **Reliability**: our users will depend on this platform for something as essential as water. That responsibility shapes how we test, how we deploy, and how we communicate. We do not ship things we are not confident in.
- **Simplicity**: the people using this platform are not developers. Borehole owners may be elderly. Administrators may have limited digital experience. We design and build for clarity and ease, removing complexity wherever it does not add value.

Agile Principles

- We deliver working software frequently, preferring shorter sprints so that feedback loops are tight and course corrections happen early.
- We welcome changing requirements, even late in development. The needs of the community may evolve as we learn more, and our process should be able to respond.
- We build around motivated individuals. Each team member was chosen for a reason and is trusted to make good decisions within their area without being micromanaged.
- Face-to-face conversation, or the closest equivalent, is our default for anything complex. Long WhatsApp threads are not a substitute for a short call.
- Working software is the primary measure of progress. A feature is done when it works in testing, not when it is written.
- Sustainable pace matters. Burning out before the final sprint helps no one. We plan realistically and communicate when capacity is stretched.
- Good design is not a luxury. A confusing interface that borehole owners cannot navigate defeats the purpose of building it. Technical excellence and good design are inseparable from our definition of done.
- At regular intervals, the team reflects on how to become more effective and adjusts its behaviour accordingly. Retrospectives are not optional.



4. Communication Plan

Communication Channels

- **WhatsApp Group**: used for daily check-ins, quick questions, sharing files, and keeping the whole team informed between meetings. Expected response time during working hours is within two hours.
- **Microsoft Teams or in-person sessions**: used for sprint planning, sprint reviews, retrospectives, and any discussion that is too complex for a text thread.
- **GitHub**: Source for all code. Pull requests are used for all changes, and every PR requires at least one review before merging. Issues are used to track bugs and tasks.

Meeting Cadence

- Sprint Planning: held at the start of every two-week sprint. The team reviews the backlog, agrees on what will be completed, and assigns tasks. Attendance is mandatory.
- Daily Stand-up: a short WhatsApp message each morning answering three things: what was completed yesterday, what is planned for today, and whether anything is blocked.
- Sprint Review: held at the end of each sprint. Working features are demonstrated. Stakeholder feedback is collected where possible.
- Retrospective: follows the sprint review. The team discusses what went well, what did not, and what one thing will be done differently next sprint.
- Ad hoc design and backend syncs: the UI/UX designer and backend developer schedule short working sessions as needed to align on API contracts and interface requirements before implementation begins.

5. Goals and Milestones

SMART Goals

Goal	Description	Measure	Deadline	Owner
Admin Portal	Build and deliver a working admin dashboard where operators can manage orders, borehole owner accounts, and view payment summaries	All admin CRUD functions pass QA with zero critical bugs	Week 2	Uhmar Adams, Leeroy Chakanyuka
Borehole Owner Portal	Deliver a portal where borehole owners can log in, view their earnings, track orders assigned to them, and see payout history	Owners can complete all key tasks without assistance during UAT	Week 3	Leeroy Chakanyuka, Faith Adams
Backend APIs	Complete all REST API endpoints covering authentication, order management, user roles, and payment tracking	100% of planned endpoints documented and passing integration tests	Week 4	Leeroy Chakanyuka
Test Coverage	Achieve thorough QA coverage across all major features, with all critical and high-severity bugs resolved before final release	Zero critical bugs outstanding at time of deployment	Week 6	Phatushedzo Baloyi
UAT	Conduct user acceptance testing with at least three real stakeholders including a borehole owner and an administrator representative	UAT sign-off obtained from all three participants	Week 8	Mologadi Dikgale, Faith Adams

Sprint Milestones

Sprint	Milestone	Deliverable	Target
Sprint 1	Foundation	Team charter approved, GitHub repo initialised, database schema designed, wireframes drafted	Week 1
Sprint 2	Backend Core	User authentication, borehole owner registration, and water order endpoints built and tested	Week 1 - 2
Sprint 3	Admin Dashboard MVP	Administrators can view all orders, manage borehole owner accounts, and see a payment summary	Week 3
Sprint 4	Borehole Owner Portal	Borehole owners can log in and view their earnings, order history, and payout breakdown	Week 4
Sprint 5	QA and UAT	Full regression testing completed, critical bugs resolved, user acceptance testing conducted with real stakeholders	Week 5 to 6
Sprint 6	Final Delivery	System deployed, full documentation produced, and final presentation delivered	Week 7 to 8